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Two step phosphor deposition to make a matrix array

Abstract

A method of fabricating closely spaced pcLEDs (**100**) arranged in a matrix array (**200**) of perpendicular rows and columns comprises an initial phosphor deposition step in which phosphor (**803, 905**) is deposited at alternating locations (pixels) in the matrix array in a checkerboard pattern, so that the locations (**504**) in the array at which phosphor (**803, 905**) is deposited are not adjacent to each other. In a subsequent phosphor deposition step phosphor is deposited at the alternating locations at which phosphor was not deposited in the first deposition step. In between the two phosphor deposition steps, reflective or scattering structures (**606**) may be fabricated on sidewalls of the phosphor pixels to optically isolate pcLEDs in the resulting array from each other.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority to International Application No. PCT/EP2019/085595 filed on Dec. 17, 2019, which claims priority to U.S. application Ser. No. 16/232,884 filed on Dec. 26, 2018 and European Application No. 19154680.3 filed on Jan. 31, 2019, all of which are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The invention relates generally to phosphor-converted light emitting diodes.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Semiconductor light emitting diodes and laser diodes (collectively referred to herein as “LEDs”) are among the most efficient light sources currently available. The emission spectrum of an LED typically exhibits a single narrow peak at a wavelength determined by the structure of the device and by the composition of the semiconductor materials from which it is constructed. By suitable choice of device structure and material system, LEDs may be designed to operate at ultraviolet, visible, or infrared wavelengths.

(3) LEDs may be combined with one or more wavelength converting materials (generally referred to herein as “phosphors”) that absorb light emitted by the LED and in response emit light of a longer wavelength. For such phosphor-converted LEDs (“pcLEDs”), the fraction of the light emitted by the LED that is absorbed by the phosphors depends on the amount of phosphor material in the optical path of the light emitted by the LED, for example on the concentration of phosphor material in a phosphor layer disposed on or around the LED and the thickness of the layer.

(4) Phosphor-converted LEDs may be designed so that all of the light emitted by the LED is absorbed by one or more phosphors, in which case the emission from the pcLED is entirely from the phosphors. In such cases the phosphor may be selected, for example, to emit light in a narrow spectral region that is not efficiently generated directly by an LED.

(5) Alternatively, pcLEDs may be designed so that only a portion of the light emitted by the LED is absorbed by the phosphors, in which case the emission from the pcLED is a mixture of light emitted by the LED and light emitted by the phosphors. By suitable choice of LED, phosphors, and phosphor composition, such a pcLED may be designed to emit, for example, white light having a desired color temperature and desired color-rendering properties.

(6) WO 2018/122520 A1 discloses a process for producing optoelectronic devices including a matrix array of light emitting diodes and a plurality of photoluminescent pads that are located facing at least some of the light emitting diodes. WO 95/30236 A1 discloses a process for making a pixelized phosphor structure by creating a plurality of openings in a substrate and depositing a phosphor into the openings. US 2017/200765 A1 discloses a display device with a distributed Bragg reflector structure between phosphor portions.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) This specification discloses methods for fabricating closely spaced pcLEDs arranged in a matrix array of perpendicular rows and columns. The phosphor may be deposited directly on the array of LEDs. Alternatively the phosphor may be deposited on a carrier substrate in a matrix array corresponding to the array of LEDs and later transferred to the LEDs.

(8) In either case in an initial phosphor deposition step phosphor is deposited at alternating locations (pixels) in the matrix array in a checkerboard pattern, so that the locations in the array at which phosphor is deposited are not adjacent to each other. Phosphor is deposited at half, or about

half, of the locations in the array in this first step. In a subsequent phosphor deposition step phosphor is deposited at the alternating locations at which phosphor was not deposited in the first deposition step. In between the two phosphor deposition steps, reflective structures may be fabricated on side walls of the phosphor pixels to optically isolate pcLEDs in the resulting array from each other.

(9) An advantage of this method is that there are typically no high aspect ratio structures in the matrix array when the reflective structures are deposited, which facilitates their deposition. Another advantage is that the spacing between the pixels is equal to the reflector thickness, which may be very thin. The reflector thickness may be, for example, less than or equal to about 10 microns, less than or equal to about 5 microns, less than or equal to about 3 microns, or less than or equal to about 0.2 microns.

(10) Phosphor-converted LEDs fabricated by the methods disclosed herein may be employed for example in microLED arrays used in displays, in LED arrays used for illumination in automobiles (for example, in headlights), and in flash light sources for cameras.

(11) Other embodiments, features and advantages of the present invention will become more apparent to those skilled in the art when taken with reference to the following more detailed description of the invention in conjunction with the accompanying drawings that are first briefly described.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 shows a schematic cross-sectional view of an example pcLED.

(2) FIGS. 2A and 2B show, respectively, cross-sectional and top schematic views of an array of pcLEDs.

(3) FIG. 3A shows a schematic top view an electronics board on which an array of pcLEDs may be mounted, and FIG. 3B similarly shows an array of pcLEDs mounted on the electronic board of FIG. 3A.

(4) FIG. 4A shows a schematic cross sectional view of an array of pcLEDs arranged with respect to waveguides and a projection lens.

(5) FIG. 4B shows an arrangement similar to that of FIG. 4A, without the waveguides.

(6) FIG. 5 shows a schematic top view of an example checkerboard patterned structure that may be employed in phosphor deposition methods described herein.

(7) FIGS. 6A-6I illustrate intermediate stages in the fabrication of a pcLED array by one variation of the phosphor deposition methods described herein.

(8) FIGS. 7A-7D illustrate intermediate stages in the fabrication of a pcLED array by another variation of the phosphor deposition methods described herein.

(9) FIGS. 8A-8B illustrate intermediate stages in the fabrication of a pcLED array by another variation of the phosphor deposition methods described herein.

(10) FIGS. 9A-9E illustrate intermediate stages in the fabrication of a pcLED array by another variation of the phosphor deposition methods described herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(11) The following detailed description should be read with reference to the drawings, in which identical reference numbers refer to like elements throughout the different figures. The drawings, which are not necessarily to scale, depict selective embodiments and are not intended to limit the scope of the invention. The detailed description illustrates by way of example, not by way of limitation, the principles of the invention.

(12) FIG. 1 shows an example of an individual pcLED **100** comprising a semiconductor diode structure **102** disposed on a substrate **104**, together considered herein an “LED”, and a phosphor

layer **106** disposed on the LED. Semiconductor diode structure **102** typically comprises an active region disposed between n-type and p-type layers. Application of a suitable forward bias across the diode structure results in emission of light from the active region. The wavelength of the emitted light is determined by the composition and structure of the active region.

(13) The LED may be, for example, a III-Nitride LED that emits blue, violet, or ultraviolet light. LEDs formed from any other suitable material system and that emit any other suitable wavelength of light may also be used. Other suitable material systems may include, for example, III-Phosphide materials, III-Arsenide materials, and II-VI materials.

(14) Any suitable phosphor materials may be used, depending on the desired optical output from the pcLED.

(15) FIGS. **2A-2B** show, respectively, cross-sectional and top views of an array **200** of pcLEDs **100** including phosphor pixels **106** disposed on a substrate **202**. Such an array may include any suitable number of pcLEDs arranged in any suitable manner. In the illustrated example the array is depicted as formed monolithically on a shared substrate, but alternatively an array of pcLEDs may be formed from separate individual pcLEDs. Substrate **202** may optionally comprise CMOS circuitry for driving the LED, and may be formed from any suitable materials.

(16) As shown in FIGS. **3A-3B**, a pcLED array **200** may be mounted on an electronics board **300** comprising a power and control module **302**, a sensor module **304**, and an LED attach region **306**. Power and control module **302** may receive power and control signals from external sources and signals from sensor module **304**, based on which power and control module **302** controls operation of the LEDs. Sensor module **304** may receive signals from any suitable sensors, for example from temperature or light sensors. Alternatively, pcLED array **200** may be mounted on a separate board (not shown) from the power and control module and the sensor module.

(17) Individual pcLEDs may optionally incorporate or be arranged in combination with a lens or other optical element located adjacent to or disposed on the phosphor layer. Such an optical element, not shown in the figures, may be referred to as a “primary optical element”. In addition, as shown in FIGS. **4A-4B** a pcLED array **200** (for example, mounted on an electronics board **300**) may be arranged in combination with secondary optical elements such as waveguides, lenses, or both for use in an intended application. In FIG. **4A**, light emitted by pcLEDs **100** is collected by waveguides **402** and directed to projection lens **404**. Projection lens **404** may be a Fresnel lens, for example. This arrangement may be suitable for use, for example, in automobile headlights. In FIG. **4B**, light emitted by pcLEDs **100** is collected directly by projection lens **404** without use of intervening waveguides. This arrangement may particularly be suitable when pcLEDs can be spaced sufficiently close to each other, and may also be used in automobile headlights as well as in camera flash applications. A microLED display application may use similar optical arrangements to those depicted in FIGS. **4A-4B**, for example. Generally, any suitable arrangement of optical elements may be used in combination with the pcLEDs described herein, depending on the desired application.

(18) For many uses of pcLED arrays, it is desirable to compartmentalize the light emitted from the individual pcLEDs in the array. That is, it is advantageous to be able to operate an individual pcLED in the array as a light source while adjacent pcLEDs in the array remain dark. This allows for better control of displays or of illumination.

(19) It is also advantageous in many applications to place the pcLEDs in the array close together. For example, a preferred configuration in microLEDs is to have minimal spacing between the individual LEDs. Closely spacing the pcLEDs in an array used as a camera flash light source or in an automobile headlight may simplify the requirements on any secondary optics and improve the illumination provided by the array.

(20) However, if pcLEDs in an array are placed close together, optical cross talk between adjacent pcLEDs may occur. That is, light emitted by a pcLED may scatter into or otherwise couple into an adjacent pcLED and appear to originate from that other pcLED, preventing the desired

compartmentalization of light.

(21) The possibility of optical crosstalk between pixels in an array prohibits the use of a single shared phosphor layer on top an array of LEDs. Instead, patterned phosphor deposition providing a discrete pixel of phosphor on each light emitting element is needed, in combination with reflecting sidewalls on the phosphor pixels.

(22) If the spacing between the LEDs in the array is small, for instance smaller than 10 or 20 microns, it is difficult to form reflecting side walls on the phosphor pixels with wet chemical or physical deposition methods due to the high aspect ratios of the channels to be filled or coated. The most common scattering layer used as a side coat for LEDs comprises TiO₂ scattering particles embedded in silicone. Another option is a reflective metal layer, such as for instance aluminum or silver. Yet another option is a multilayer Distributed Bragg Reflector (DBR) structure formed from a stack of alternating layers of high and low refractive index material, which can provide very high reflectance depending on design. To ensure uniform coating of such reflective layers or structures on the side walls of the phosphor pixels, the side walls should be accessible. If the aspect ratio of the gap between adjacent phosphor pixels is high, inhomogeneities in the reflective coating thickness can be expected leading to non-uniform, non-optimal reflecting properties.

(23) This specification discloses a method of coating the side walls of phosphor pixels that may be employed to produce a pcLED array with very close spacing of adjacent pcLEDs. As summarized above, in a first phosphor deposition step only half (or about half) of the phosphor pixels are deposited, in a checkerboard pattern. For example, for a matrix array having an even number of pixels half of the phosphor pixels may be deposited in the first phosphor deposition step. For a matrix array having an odd number of pixels half plus or minus 1 of the phosphor pixels may be deposited in the first phosphor deposition step. After the first phosphor deposition step (and removal of any patterned structures or molds used in the first deposition step) the reflecting side coats are deposited. At this stage in the method no high aspect ratio structures are present in the system to interfere with deposition of the reflecting side coats. In a following step the remaining phosphor pixels are deposited, leading to a pixelated matrix array of phosphor pixels each with reflecting side coats.

(24) FIG. 5 shows a top view of an example 7×7 checkerboard pattern structure **502** that may be used in this method. As further described below, structure **502** may be formed, for example, from a photoresist or as an optionally reusable mold. Similar larger or smaller M×N structures may be employed, in which M and N may be equal or may be different. Structure **502** comprises rectangular (e.g., square) openings **504** alternating with rectangular (e.g., square) features of the structure to form the checkerboard pattern. These rectangular features of structure **502** may be blocks of photoresist or portions of a mold, for example. Structure **502** further comprises thin rectangular openings **506** arranged around the edge of the checkerboard pattern adjacent to outer ones of the rectangular features in the structure.

(25) As further described below, openings **504** are used to form phosphor pixels in the first phosphor deposition step. The function of openings **506** is to provide, after the first phosphor deposition step, a surface onto which a mirror structure can be deposited. Otherwise the outer pixels formed during the second phosphor deposition step described below would lack an outer mirror structure. Phosphor deposited in openings **506** is not used for light generation.

(26) As an example, square openings **504** in structure **502** may be 200 microns in width, and thin rectangular openings **506** may be 200 microns in length and 50 microns in width. The rectangular features in the checkerboard pattern of structure **502** are wider and longer than openings **504** by twice the width of the reflective side coatings to be deposited on the pixelated phosphor array, in this example about two times 10 microns. The resulting pixel size and spacing may be suitable for a flash module, for example.

(27) Smaller sizes may easily be created, for example 32×32 micron pixels with 8 micron streets (pixel spacing, reflector width), 35×35 micron pixels with 5 micron streets, and 37×37 micron

pixels with 3 micron streets. Larger pixel sizes may be used as well. Any other suitable dimensions may be used.

(28) FIGS. **6A-6I** show a partial cross-sectional view of structure **502** taken along cut line **503** shown in FIG. **5**. Referring now to these figures, in one variation of this method checkerboard pattern **502** is formed from photoresist deposited on a carrier **602** (FIG. **6A**). Any suitable photoresist may be used, and the photoresist may be patterned using any suitable conventional methods. Carrier **602** may be for example a glass sheet, or any other suitable material.

(29) Subsequently, as shown in FIG. **6B**, openings **504** in structure **502** are filled with phosphor material to form phosphor pixels **604**. Thin rectangular openings **506** in structure **502** are also filled with phosphor material at this step. The phosphor material may comprise, for example, any suitable phosphor particles dispersed in any suitable matrix material. Suitable matrix materials may include, for example, silicones, sol gels, and low melting point glasses. The phosphor pixels may be deposited by any suitable method, for instance by blade coating or by spray coating. Excess phosphor material may be removed from the top of structure **502** by, for example, rinsing or wiping or a combination of the two. Phosphor pixels **604** may then be cured or partially cured to such an extent that the photoresist forming structure **502** may be stripped without affecting the phosphor layer.

(30) Subsequently, as shown in FIG. **6C**, the photoresist forming structure **502** is stripped from carrier **602**, leaving phosphor pixels **604** with their side walls exposed. The photoresist may be stripped with a solvent or by dry etching, for example, or by any other suitable method.

(31) Optionally, after stripping of the photoresist the phosphor matrix can be cured further. Also optionally, to arrest metal migration or to improve adhesion of a reflecting layer on the phosphor pixels, intermediate layers may be deposited on the phosphor pixels or the phosphor pixels may be treated with a plasma or exposed to UV/Ozone. Subsequently, as shown in FIG. **6D**, a reflecting layer **606** may be deposited on the top and the side walls of phosphor pixels **604**. Advantageously, at this stage the side walls of pixels **604** are easily accessed because the neighboring phosphor pixels have not yet been deposited. Reflecting layer **606** may be or comprise, for example, a light scattering material such as TiO₂ particles embedded in silicone, one or more reflective metal layers, or one or more DBR structures. Reflective metal layers may be deposited by vapor deposition or sputtering, for example. DBR structures may be deposited by atomic layer deposition, for example.

(32) Reflective layer **606** may have a thickness on side walls of phosphor pixels **604** of, for example less than or equal to about 0.2 microns, less than or equal to about 3 microns, less than or equal to about 5 microns, less than or equal to about 10 microns, or less than or equal to about 20 microns. An aluminum mirror reflective structure may have a thickness less than or equal to about 0.2 microns, for example. A DBR structure may have a thickness of less than or equal to about 3 microns, for example. In the final phosphor array structure, the thickness of these reflector sidewalls is also the spacing between phosphor pixels.

(33) Subsequently, as shown in FIG. **6E**, after deposition of reflecting layer **606**, a second phosphor layer application step is carried out to deposit phosphor pixels **608**. Phosphor pixels **608** are located where the rectangular features in the checkerboard pattern of structure **502** (shown in FIG. **5**) were previously located. The phosphor structures formed by filling thin rectangular openings **506** in the previous phosphor deposition step prevent phosphor material deposited in the second phosphor deposition step from flowing out of the array.

(34) The phosphor material deposited in the second deposition step to form pixels **608** may be the same as that deposited in the first deposition step to form pixels, **604**. Alternatively, the phosphor materials used in the two separate deposition steps may differ. For example, the phosphor materials use in the two steps may comprise the same phosphors, and hence have the same or similar spectral characteristics, but differ in the matrix material in which the phosphor particles are dispersed. Alternatively, the phosphor materials used in the two different deposition steps may use the same

matrix material but comprise different phosphors having different spectral characteristics. For example, in one of the deposition steps a phosphor providing a warm white light output may be deposited while in the other phosphor deposition step a phosphor providing a cool white light output may be deposited. This would result in a matrix with about half warm white pixels and about half cool white pixels, which might be advantageously employed in a camera flash application for example. The phosphor materials used in the two separate deposition steps may also differ in both matrix and phosphor. After the second phosphor deposition step, the portion of the reflective layers on top of phosphor pixels **604** are removed by chemical or mechanical means, for example, resulting in the phosphor pixel array shown in FIG. 6F.

(35) As shown in FIG. 6G, the phosphor pixel array shown in FIG. 6F may be inverted and bonded to an array of LEDs **610** arranged on a substrate **612**, with the phosphor pixels aligned with corresponding LEDs. This results in the structure shown in FIG. 6H.

(36) Subsequently, carrier **602** and portions of reflective layer **606** present on carrier **602** are removed by polishing or grinding (lapping). This results in the pcLED array shown in FIG. 6I, in which adjacent closely spaced phosphor pixels **614** are separated by reflective side walls **616**.

(37) Referring now to the partial cross-sectional views shown in FIGS. 7A-7D, in another variation of the phosphor deposition method an optionally reusable mold **702** having openings as shown in FIG. 5, for example, is used instead of a photoresist pattern. Openings in the mold are filled with a phosphor material to form phosphor pixels **704**, and excess phosphor is removed from the top surface of the mold (FIG. 7A).

(38) The mold may be formed from boron-nitride, for example, and may be used for example in combination with phosphor materials that cure at a higher temperature than photoresists can withstand. The phosphor material may be, for example, a phosphor in glass (PiG) material. Any other suitable phosphor materials may be used instead. For example, the phosphor material may comprise a silicone or sol-gel matrix as described above, rather than a glass matrix.

(39) Subsequently, phosphor pixels **704** are cured. For a PiG material, phosphor pixels **704** may be cured at about 480° C., for example. The phosphor material may but will not necessarily shrink during curing, as depicted in FIG. 7B. This might be compensated for by over-filling the mold (see for example FIG. 8A discussed below).

(40) Subsequently, the mold is inverted on a carrier **706** (FIG. 7C), and the mold is removed after a further heating step that softens the phosphor material to attach and leave phosphor pixels **704** on the substrate after cooling and removal of the mold. The carrier may be a glass sheet, for example, or any other suitable material. If the phosphor material has shrunk as depicted in FIG. 7B-7C, it might be difficult to get it to release from the mold.

(41) Alternatively, the phosphor material, a PiG material for example, is deposited in the voids of the mold. Before curing the phosphor material, the substrate **706** is attached to the mold and the mold and substrate assembly is flipped to a configuration as shown in FIG. 7C followed by a high temperature curing step. The high temperature curing step, carried out at about 480° C. for example, may be done under reduced pressure to improve the density of the phosphor pixels **704** and the adhesion to the substrate **706**.

(42) Subsequent steps in forming the pcLED array in this variation of the method may generally track those described with respect to FIGS. 6D-6I.

(43) Referring now to the partial cross-sectional views shown in FIG. 8A-8B, another variation of the phosphor deposition method uses an optionally reusable mold **702** as shown in FIG. 7A but overfills the mold with phosphor material **803** (FIG. 8A). As shown, in FIG. 8B, after removal from the mold this results in a monolithic phosphor structure comprising phosphor pixels **804** connected to each other by a phosphor material carrier **806**. Carrier **806** plays a role similar to carrier **706** shown in FIG. 7C. Subsequent steps in forming the pcLED array in this variation of the method may generally track those described with respect to FIGS. 6D-6I.

(44) In another variation of the phosphor deposition method, a checkerboard pattern as shown in

FIG. 5 is formed by depositing a boron nitride grid on substrate **706**. Such a boron nitride grid might be prepared by micromachining, for example. Alternatively, a frame formed from boron nitride, for example, may be attached to or brought in contact with the substrate **706**.

(45) The frame or grid may be filled with phosphor material such as a PiG material followed by a high temperature curing step that leads to a phosphor pixel on substrate configuration as shown in FIG. 7D, after removal of the frame or grid. For the filling process a PiG material can be mixed with a liquid binder to obtain a paste or slurry. The paste or slurry can then be dosed into the openings of the frame or grid by methods such as casting or dispensing, for example, followed by steps of drying and removal of the binder additives. Subsequent steps in forming the pcLED array by these variations of the method may generally track those described with respect to FIGS. 6D-6I, with the boron nitride grid substituted for the photoresist pattern.

(46) In variations in which a PiG material is deposited in a mold or frame, the mold or frame may be removed after glass melting and solidification at a temperature chosen to maintain the pixel shape while avoiding mechanical stress resulting from mismatches between the coefficients of thermal expansion of the mold or frame and the substrate, for example at the glass softening or annealing temperature.

(47) Referring now to the partial cross-sectional view of FIG. 9A, in another variation of the phosphor deposition method the phosphor material is deposited directly on an LED array **900**. LED array **900** comprises LEDs **100** arranged on a substrate **902** in a rectangular array. Substrate **902** may comprise CMOS configured to drive the LEDs via interconnects and contacts **903**.

(48) As shown in FIG. 9B, a checkerboard photoresist pattern **502** is deposited on LED array **900**, overlying alternate LEDs. A passivating dielectric layer may be deposited on the LED array before deposition of the photoresist.

(49) Subsequently, as shown in FIG. 9C a phosphor material **905** is deposited in the checkerboard photoresist pattern. Excess phosphor is removed from the top of the LED array, leaving phosphor pixels **604** in place over corresponding LEDs (FIG. 9D). The photoresist pattern may then be removed, similarly to as described for other variations of the method, resulting in the structure shown in FIG. 9E.

(50) Subsequent steps in forming the pcLED array in this variation of the method may generally track those described with respect to FIGS. 6D-6I.

(51) In variations of the phosphor deposition method employing a photoresist pattern **502** in combination with a phosphor material comprising phosphor particles dispersed in a silicone matrix, it is desirable to cure the silicone matrix at a temperature that satisfactorily cures the silicone but is sufficiently low to avoid baking or damaging the photoresist and making the photoresist difficult to remove.

(52) Such low temperature curing may be facilitated, for example, by using a condensation cure silicone composition for the matrix, and curing it using vapor phase catalyzation. The condensation cure silicone composition may comprise organosiloxane block copolymers, for example. The vapor phase catalyst may be for example a basic or alkaline catalyzing agent. Superbase catalysts such as described in U.S. Pat. No. 9,688,035 by Swier et. al. can be used.

(53) The term “superbase” used herein refers to compounds having a very high basicity, such as lithium diisopropylamide. The term “superbase” also encompasses bases resulting from a mixing of two (or more) bases leading to new basic species possessing inherent new properties. The term “superbase” does not necessarily mean a base that is thermodynamically and/or kinetically stronger than another. Instead, in some variations it means that a basic reagent is created by combining the characteristics of several different bases. The term “superbase” also encompasses any species with a higher absolute proton affinity (APA=245.3 kcal/mole) and intrinsic gas phase basicity (GB=239 kcal/mole) relative to 1,8-bis-(dimethylamino)-naphthalene. Non-limiting examples of superbases include organic superbases, organometallic superbases, and inorganic superbases.

(54) Organic superbases include but are not limited to nitrogen-containing compounds. In some

embodiments, the nitrogen-containing compounds also have low nucleophilicity and relatively mild conditions of use. Non-limiting examples of nitrogen-containing compounds include phosphazenes, amidines, guanidines, and multicyclic polyamines. Organic superbases also include compounds where a reactive metal has been exchanged for a hydrogen on a heteroatom, such as oxygen (unstabilized alkoxides) or nitrogen (metal amides such as lithium diisopropylamide). In some embodiments, the superbase catalyst is an amidine compound. In some embodiments, the term “superbase” refers to organic superbases having at least two nitrogen atoms and a pK_b of from about 0.5 to about 11, as measured in water.

(55) Organometallic superbases include, but are not limited to, organolithium and organomagnesium (Grignard reagent) compounds. In some variations, the organometallic superbases are hindered to the extent necessary to make them non-nucleophilic.

(56) Superbases also include mixtures of organic, organometallic, and/or inorganic superbases. A non-limited example of such mixed superbases is the Schlosser base (or Lochmann-Schlosser base), which is the combination of n-butyllithium and potassium tert-butoxide. The combination of n-butyllithium and potassium tert-butoxide form a mixed aggregate of greater reactivity than either reagent alone and with distinctly different properties in comparison to tert-butylpotassium.

(57) Inorganic superbases include salt-like compounds with small, highly charged anions. Non-limiting examples of inorganic superbases include lithium nitride and alkali- and alkali earth metal hydrides including potassium hydride and sodium hydride. Such species are insoluble in all solvents owing to the strong cation-anion interactions, but the surfaces of these materials are highly reactive and slurries can be used.

(58) In some variations the superbase catalyst comprises 1,8-Diazabicyclo[5.4.0]undec-7-ene (DBU), (CAS #6674-22-2)

(59) The amount of the superbase catalyst used can vary and is not limiting. Typically, the amount added through vapor phase is a catalytically effective amount, which may vary depending on the superbase selected, and vapor permeation properties of the siloxane polymer resin. The amount of superbase catalyst is typically measured in parts per million (ppm) in the solid composition. In particular, the catalyst level is calculated in regard to copolymer solids. The amount of superbase catalyst added to the curable silicone compositions may range from 0.1 to 1,000 ppm, alternatively from 1 to 500 ppm, or alternatively from 10 to 100 ppm, as based on the polymer resin content (by weight) present in the solid compositions.

(60) The silicone material or siloxanes can be selected for mechanical stability, low temperature cure properties (e.g. below 150-120 degrees Celsius), and ability to be catalyzed using vapor phase catalysts. In some variations, organosiloxane block copolymers can be used. Organopolysiloxanes containing D and T units, where the D unit are primarily bonded together to form linear blocks having 10 to 400 D units and the T units are primarily bonded to each other to form branched polymeric chains, which are referred to as “non-linear blocks” can be used.

(61) This disclosure is illustrative and not limiting. Further modifications will be apparent to one skilled in the art in light of this disclosure and are intended to fall within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A matrix array of phosphor pixels comprising: a carrier; a plurality of first phosphor pixels positioned on the carrier to form a first checkerboard pattern comprising an array of an equal number of rows and columns in which first phosphor pixels are positioned in alternating locations in the matrix array alternating with locations in which first phosphor pixels are not positioned, each of the first phosphor pixels comprising a top surface, a bottom surface opposite the top surface, and sidewalls connecting the top surface and the bottom surface, the first phosphor pixels each comprising a first phosphor; a plurality of second phosphor pixels positioned on the carrier to form

a second checkerboard pattern comprising an array of the equal number of rows and columns in which the second phosphor pixels are positioned in alternating locations in the matrix array alternating with locations in which the first phosphor pixels are positioned, each of the second phosphor pixels comprising a top surface, a bottom surface opposite the top surface, and sidewalls connecting the top surface and the bottom surface, the second phosphor pixels each comprising a second phosphor that is a different phosphor from the first phosphor, the second phosphor pixels not comprising the first phosphor; a plurality of reflective structures disposed between sidewalls of the first phosphor pixels and the second phosphor pixels adjacent to each other, and disposed between second phosphor pixels and the carrier.

2. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the reflective structures comprise sidewalls that are disposed between sidewalls of the first phosphor pixels and the second phosphor pixels adjacent to each other, and a bottom surface connecting the sidewalls.
3. The matrix array of claim 2, wherein the bottom surface of the reflective structures is in direct contact with the carrier.
4. The matrix array of claim 2, wherein the bottom surface of the reflective structures is in direct contact with the second phosphor pixels.
5. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the reflective structures are not positioned between the first phosphor pixels and the carrier.
6. The matrix array of claim 5, wherein the first phosphor pixels are in direct contact with the carrier.
7. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the first phosphor pixels have sidewalls with greater heights than heights of sidewalls of the second phosphor pixels.
8. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein a planar shape of the top surface of the first phosphor pixels is a square shape and a planar shape of the top surface of second phosphor pixels is a square shape.
9. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the matrix array further comprises thin rectangular phosphor walls disposed at the outer edges of the matrix array to surround the first checkerboard pattern and the second checkerboard pattern, each of the thin rectangular phosphor walls having a top surface having a non-square planar shape.
10. The matrix array of claim 9, wherein a length of the top surface of the thin rectangular phosphor walls is a same length as a length of the top surface of the first phosphor pixels or of the second phosphor pixels, and a width of the top surface of the thin rectangular phosphor walls is a different width than a width of the top surface of the first phosphor pixels or of the second phosphor pixels.
11. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the first phosphor pixels and the second phosphor pixels adjacent to each other are spaced apart by less than or equal to about 10 microns by the reflective structures.
12. The matrix array of claim 11, wherein the first phosphor pixels and the second phosphor pixels adjacent to each other are spaced apart by less than or equal to about 3 microns by the reflective structures.
13. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the reflective structures comprise at least one of aluminum, silver, and a multilayer Distributed Bragg Reflector structure.
14. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the first phosphor pixels and the second phosphor pixels comprise at least one of silicone, sol gel, and glass.
15. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein at least one of the first phosphor pixels and the second phosphor pixels comprises organosiloxane block copolymers.
16. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the first phosphor has different spectral characteristics than the second phosphor.
17. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the first phosphors pixels comprise first phosphors with same spectral characteristics as second phosphors comprised in the second phosphor pixels, and the

first phosphor pixels comprise a first matrix material in which the first phosphors are dispersed that is a different matrix material than the second matrix material comprised in the second phosphor pixels in which the second phosphors are dispersed.

18. The matrix array of claim 1, wherein the carrier is glass.

19. A method of fabricating a matrix array of phosphor-converted LEDs, the method comprising: depositing first phosphor material in openings in a mold; curing the first phosphor material deposited in the openings in the mold; inverting the mold to deposit the first phosphor material at alternating locations in a matrix array to form a checkerboard pattern of first phosphor pixels in which locations in the matrix array at which first phosphor pixels are deposited alternate with locations in the array at which first phosphor pixels are not deposited, the checkerboard pattern comprising an array of an equal number of rows and columns, the first phosphor pixels comprising side walls adjacent to and facing the locations in the array at which the first phosphor pixels are not deposited, the first phosphor pixels comprising a same first phosphor as each other; depositing reflective structures on the side walls of the first phosphor pixels; and after depositing the reflective structures, depositing a second phosphor material to form second phosphor pixels at the alternating locations in the matrix array at which the first phosphor pixels are not deposited, such that the first phosphor pixels adjacent to the second phosphor pixels in the resulting matrix array are in contact with and spaced apart by the reflective structures.

20. A method of fabricating a matrix array of phosphor-converted LEDs, the method comprising: depositing a first phosphor material in openings in a mold to overfill the openings; curing the first phosphor material deposited in the openings in the mold to overfill the openings; inverting the mold, then removing the mold to provide a monolithic phosphor structure comprising first phosphor pixels at alternating locations in a matrix array forming a checkerboard pattern so that locations in the matrix array at which phosphor pixels are deposited alternate with locations in the array at which phosphor pixels are not deposited, the checkerboard pattern comprising an array of an equal number of rows and columns, the first phosphor pixels comprising side walls adjacent to and facing the locations in the array at which phosphor pixels are not deposited, the first phosphor pixels connected to each other by a phosphor material carrier, the first phosphor pixels comprising a same first phosphor as each other; depositing reflective structures on the side walls of the first phosphor pixels; and after depositing the reflective structures, depositing a second phosphor material to form second phosphor pixels at the alternating locations in the matrix array at which the first phosphor pixels are not deposited, such that the first phosphor pixels adjacent to the second phosphor pixels in the resulting matrix array are in contact with and spaced apart by the reflective structures.
